

23. St. Peters (Island) – Governors Island

Shoreline length: 10 km



Shore Types

St. Peters-Governors Islands are two islands located on the southeast end of PEI. Shore type characterized by a majority of low plains.

% Shore types within SMU

low plain	bluff	sloped armour	cliff	wetland	vertical struct.	dunes	sandspit
68	22	0	6	4	0	0	0

Governance, Infrastructure, and Economy

This SMU consists of uninhabited islands and is unincorporated, with no infrastructure or coastal economic drivers.

Natural Assets and Heritage

St. Peters Island is a Natural Area. Governor's Island is managed by the Nature Conservancy of Canada. A historical lighthouse is located on the south coast of the island.



Source: lighthousefriends.com

Planning and Policy Framework

Provincial rules apply. Land use and development is managed under provincial development standards, which include horizontal coastal building setbacks based on edge of feature and a calculation of erosion over time, building setbacks for dunes, and a requirement for a coastal buffer for new subdivisions. There are no specific flood elevations identified in regulations, but coastal hazard assessments are typically conducted.

Coastal Flood and Erosion Risk

The sediment transport around the inner islands is moderate. The islands are entirely undeveloped, therefore flooding or shoreline change hazards do not translate into risk, except for the Lighthouse.

The Lighthouse is presently located approximately 20 m from the edge of the cliff. Based on projected erosion rates in the order of 0.5 m/year, it would be at risk within the next 40 years.

Proposed SMP Strategies

A No Active Intervention strategy is recommended for all three epochs.

This will preserve natural habitat and shoreline processes. The local shoreline and hazard zone should remain natural, undeveloped.

The Lighthouse should be moved back in the short- to medium-term (to be confirmed by ongoing erosion monitoring), before the setback to the cliff edge is typically 10 m or less.